

TaxScout Data Retention and Disposal Policy

Effective date: August 22, 2026

Owner: Founder, TaxScout

1. Purpose

This policy describes how long TaxScout retains user data and how that data is disposed of when no longer needed.

2. Data Retained

- Account data (email, profile, state, income range)
- Transaction data synced from connected bank accounts (via Plaid)
- Plaid access tokens for connected accounts
- Subscription/billing status (via Stripe; TaxScout does not store card data)

3. Retention Period

Data is retained for as long as the user maintains an active TaxScout account. There is no independent retention schedule beyond the user's own account lifecycle — TaxScout does not retain data for a fixed period after it is no longer needed for the purposes above.

4. Disposal

- **Disconnecting a bank account** (available anytime from Settings) immediately revokes the associated Plaid access token via Plaid's `/item/remove` endpoint and deletes the corresponding record from TaxScout's database.
- **Deleting an account** (available anytime from Settings) removes the user's profile, transaction history, and any linked-account records from TaxScout's database.
- Deletion is enforced through the application's delete-account flow, which performs the removal directly against the database at the time of the request.

5. Review

As a single-founder-operated product, this policy does not yet have a formal periodic review cycle. It reflects TaxScout's current, actual data handling practices and will be revisited as the product and its data volume grow.